

Let's YouTube! – From Consumer to Creator

Introduction

Young people are spending a lot of their time on YouTube every day watching mindless hours of videos. In 2021, a research (see appendix) conducted with 2,256 students (S2 and S3) from 14 schools in Hong Kong shows that 51.8% of the students spend more than 4 hours per day on the Internet, while 13.9% spend more than 7 hours. The research indicates that the top activity students engage in is 'watching videos', in which YouTube is the most visited video streaming platform. Many parents complain that YouTube is a major time-waster for their kids, but we believe that YouTube can be a very good tool for developing creativity, entrepreneurship, and a sphere of influence if young people learn to master this tool instead of being mastered by it. This class leverages on the existing interest of kids in YouTube and transforms their habit of idle consumption into active construction.

Objectives of the class:

- Develop 21st century skills: digital literacy, research competency, cyber security, networking & people skill
- Learn design thinking. Practice the habit of starting before you're ready, getting feedback, iterating
- Acquire writing, filming and video editing skills
- Start a YouTube channel. Make and post a video each week. Build a portfolio
- Discover/further develop an interest e.g. sell something, teach something, solve a problem
- Replace a negative addictive habit with a new constructive one

Strategy to achieving program objectives:

The course focuses on transforming passive consumption into active creation while fostering a sense of community among students. Over the course of 8 sessions, students will engage in activities such as brainstorming their own personal YouTube channels, setting up their channels, learning cyber safety, shooting and posting videos with clickbait titles and thumbnails, editing videos, and promoting channels through networking and support. These activities aim to develop digital literacy, critical thinking, research skills, creativity, and networking abilities. Students learn to create engaging content, give and receive constructive feedback, and build their personal brand. This course has 8 sessions, about 1.5 hours each.

Learning Approach:

- Social-emotional learning
- Interactive learning e.g. role play, Pair and Share

- Collaborative learning
- Technology-mediated interaction e.g. using tools such as Google Draw, Mentimeter
- Self-directed learning
- Problem-based learning

Impact on beneficiaries:

Improved digital and media literacy; Proper practice in media consumption and active media creation; Increased creativity and entrepreneurial spirit; Improved confidence and self-expression.

Skills acquired:

Writing, filming and video editing skills, networking & people skill

Knowledge acquired:

Design Thinking, digital literacy, research competency, cyber security, entrepreneurship

Practical application/relevancy

Vocation benefits including enriched CV, skill set and creativity

Course Outline

Lessons 1

- Ground rules and Zoom etiquette
Objectives: Co-create rules for this class, for in-person and online meetings (if applicable)
- Students share their favorite videos and YouTube channels (observing the channel description, and the number of likes, asking questions such as why people like it? What value has the video added to you? What info is given?)
Objectives: Get to know one another, ice break, learn critical thinking
- Brainstorm their own channel
Objectives:
 - Explore their own interests and passions
 - Solve a problem/sell something/teach something
 - Learn about personal branding and YouTube as a portfolio for future interviews, scholarships, and job hunts. YouTube can be used to show a track record, a history of what you have done.

Lessons 2

- Set up a YouTube Channel
Objectives: Develop research skills – check out at least 5 other similar channels and read their channel descriptions. Write a description, and choose a photo for their own channels.
- Learn how to give constructive feedback
Objectives: Master the “sandwich feedback” method and be able to write specific, objective, and constructive evaluations.
- Get feedback from peers
Objectives: Practice design thinking

Lessons 3

- Learn cyber safety
Objectives: Recognize that what's up on the internet can never be erased. Students will learn to think before they post any comments, videos, or content.
- Shoot a video
Objectives: Explore existing cameras and editing software available
- Post a video
Objectives: Research and create clickbait titles and thumbnails

Lessons 4

- Edit a video
Objectives: Learn basic editing skills such as cutting footage, adding music, footage transitioning, adding text to clips, etc. Cultivating Students' Copyright Awareness
- Film another video using skills learned in previous lessons
Objective: Use teacher and peer feedback to improve on their filming, editing, and content-creating skills.
- Share channel and video. Get subscribers and likes.
Objectives:
 - Connect and network with contacts such as family members, friends, teachers, and schoolmates to promote their channels
 - Support classmates in this course by sharing one another's videos
- Practice giving one another affirmations
Objectives: Build confidence, community, and comradery

Equipment need

An iPhone/iPad for each student.

Language

English/Chinese

Course Instructor

Our course instructors are trained personally by Ms. Balica Ng, who developed the course content and is Project Manager at *Youth Global Network*. Balica holds a master's degree in Education, specializing in Psychological Studies in Education. She started her journey as an educator in 2011 and was a business co-owner of *Touch the World Creative Art Platform*. Balica was also previously a full-time Learning and Development Trainer at *The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology*, as well as a volunteering Inclusive Job Coach at The Dialogue Academy. She enjoys bringing fun and creativity to the classroom and she has her own YouTube channel at www.youtube.com/balicang.

Appendix

<https://www.hk01.com/社會新聞/785609/上網成癮嚴重13-9-受訪學生每日上網逾7小時-逾65-曾與家人衝突>